

FINWISEBUDGET APP

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ASSIGNMENT

WALLETHUB

WalletHub

WalletHub is a financial technology (fintech) company that provides tools to help people manage their money, monitor credit scores, and compare financial products such as credit cards, loans, insurance, and bank accounts. The platform operates through a website and mobile application designed to help users make better financial decisions and improve their financial health. WalletHub is widely used by consumers looking for free financial tools, credit monitoring, and financial advice.

History and Development

WalletHub was officially launched on 5 August 2013 by its founder and CEO Odysseas Papadimitriou. The company is owned by Evolution Finance, Inc., and its headquarters are in Miami, United States. Before launching WalletHub, Papadimitriou created another financial comparison website called CardHub, which focused mainly on credit card comparisons. WalletHub expanded on this idea by adding many more financial tools and services.

Initially, WalletHub was designed as a personal finance social network where users could review and compare financial products and services. Over time, the platform evolved into a full financial management system offering credit monitoring, budgeting tools, and financial research reports. Today, WalletHub has grown into one of the most popular personal finance platforms and serves millions of users who want to improve their financial decisions.

Strengths of the WalletHub App

1. Free financial tools: Provides free credit scores, credit reports, and financial monitoring.
2. Financial product comparison: Allows users to compare credit cards, loans, bank accounts, and insurance.
3. Credit monitoring: Provides daily credit score updates and alerts.
4. Financial education: Offers financial articles, quizzes, and expert advice.
5. User reviews: Users can review financial companies and services.
6. Personalized financial advice: Provides customized recommendations to improve credit and save money.

Weaknesses of the WalletHub App

1. Limited global availability: Most financial services and comparisons focus mainly on the United States market.
2. Advertisements and promotions: Some recommendations may promote financial products.
3. Requires login for some content: Some features or content require users to create an account.

4. Privacy concerns: Users must provide personal financial information to receive full benefits.

Innovative Features of WalletHub

WalletHub has several innovative features that make it unique in the fintech space:

1. AI-based financial advisor

The platform uses technology that acts like an automated financial advisor to provide:

- Credit improvement tips
- Savings alerts
- Personalized financial recommendations.

2. Daily credit score updates

Unlike many apps that update monthly, WalletHub updates credit scores daily.

3. Wallet Fitness system

WalletHub promotes a concept called “Wallet Fitness”, which measures and improves a user’s financial health.

4. Financial product reviews

Users can review financial products like how people review restaurants on platforms like Yelp.

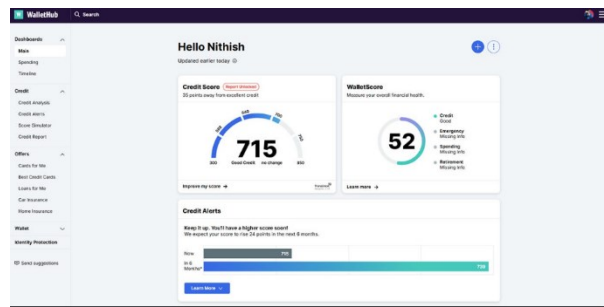
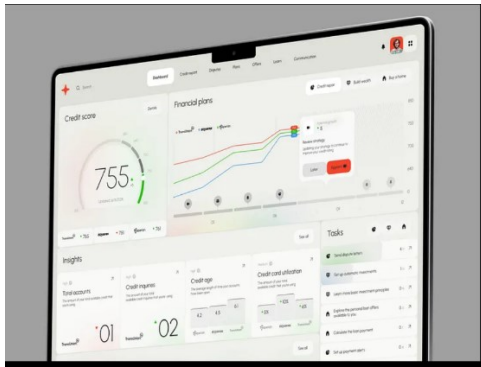
5. Financial comparison tools

Users can compare:

- credit cards
- loans
- insurance
- banking services.

Best Features to Use When Creating Your Own Budgeting App

- **1. Financial Dashboard (Overview Screen)**



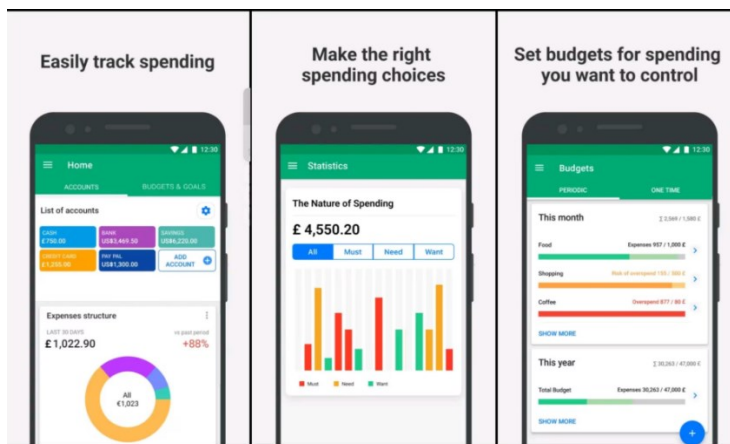
Description:

The dashboard is the main screen of the app where users see an overview of their finances. It shows important information like credit score, spending trends, and financial activity in one place.

What makes it useful:

- Displays financial data using charts and graphs.
- Shows credit score and financial health indicators.
- Provides quick access to budgeting tools.

2. Spending Tracker



Description:

A spending tracker records every transaction and shows how users spend their money.

How it works:

- Transactions are categorized automatically (food, transport, bills, etc.).
- Users can monitor where their money goes.
- Spending habits are analyzed.

Why it is powerful:

- Helps users identify unnecessary expenses.
- Shows spending trends over time.

3. Budget Planning Tool

Description:

A budgeting tool helps users plan how they will spend their income.

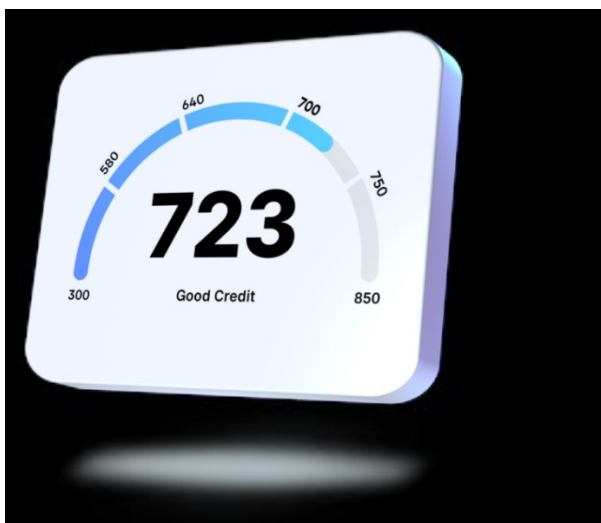
Key functions:

- Set monthly budgets
- Track progress toward budget limits
- Receive alerts when spending exceeds the budget

Example budget categories:

- groceries
- rent
- transport
- entertainment

4. Financial Health Score (WalletScore)



A promotional graphic for WalletHub. On the left, a smartphone screen displays a credit score of 723, labeled "EXCELLENT CREDIT • 4-10 PTS". It also shows "22 More Points to Next Credit Level", "Updated Today", and "87% WALLETSORE". On the right, the WalletHub logo is above the text "Reach Top WalletFitness".

Description:

WalletHub uses a WalletScore, which measures overall financial health.

The score considers:

- credit usage
- spending habits
- debt level
- savings

Why it is innovative:

It simplifies complex financial data into one easy number.

5. Subscription Manager

Description:

The subscription manager tracks recurring payments.

Examples:

- Netflix
- gym membership
- music subscriptions

Why it is useful:

Users often forget subscriptions they are paying for.

6. Financial Alerts & Notifications

Description:

The app sends notifications about important financial events.

Examples of alerts:

- unusual spending
- large transactions
- budget limits reached
- suspicious activity

7. Goal Tracking (Savings & Debt)

Description:

Users can set financial goals.

Examples:

- saving for a car
- paying off debt

- building emergency savings

References

- Wikipedia. (2025). WalletHub.
- WalletHub. About WalletHub.
- Crunchbase. WalletHub Company Profile.
- WalletHub Blog. WalletHub Launch Announcement.
- ScamDoc. WalletHub Website Analysis.

MONARCH MONEY

Overview of Monarch Money

Monarch Money is a personal finance and budgeting application that helps users manage their money, track spending, create budgets, and plan financial goals. The app combines multiple financial tools into one platform so users can monitor bank accounts, investments, debts, and expenses in a single dashboard.

The platform works on **web browsers, iOS, and Android devices**, allowing users to access their financial information from different devices. It helps individuals and families understand their financial situation and make better financial decisions.

When the App Was Developed

Monarch Money was founded in **2018** in the United States as a financial technology (fintech) startup. The company's headquarters are in **California**, and it focuses on personal financial management software.

The goal of the platform is to simplify money management by bringing together budgeting tools, financial planning, and account tracking in one application.

Founders of Monarch Money

The company was founded by three entrepreneurs:

- **Val Agostino** – Co-founder and CEO
- **Jon Sutherland** – Co-founder and Head of Design
- **Ozzie Osman** – Co-founder and Head of Engineering

The founders created the app to help people manage their financial lives more effectively and to provide a better alternative to older budgeting apps.

Strengths of the Monarch Money App

1. All-in-one financial management

Users can connect multiple financial accounts such as bank accounts, credit cards, loans, and investments to see everything in one place.

2. Goal-based financial planning

The app allows users to set financial goals such as saving money, paying off debt, or planning investments.

3. Collaboration for families or couples

Partners can share accounts and manage finances together, which makes it useful for households.

4. Ad-free experience

Unlike many free budgeting apps, Monarch Money operates using a subscription model instead of advertising.

5. Powerful financial reports

The app provides charts, graphs, and financial summaries to help users understand spending habits.

Weaknesses of the Monarch Money App

1. Subscription cost

The app requires a monthly or yearly subscription, which may discourage some users.

2. Limited global availability

Many features are designed mainly for the **United States financial system**.

3. Learning curve

Some users may find the many financial tools and options complicated when using the app for the first time.

Innovative Features of Monarch Money

1. Account aggregation

The app connects to thousands of financial institutions and combines all financial accounts in one place.

2. AI-based financial insights

The system analyzes spending patterns and provides financial recommendations.

3. Financial goal planning

Users can create financial roadmaps to reach their savings or investment goals.

4. Net-worth tracking

The app tracks assets and liabilities to calculate overall financial health.

Best Features You Can Use When Creating Your Own Budgeting App

1. Financial Dashboard

Description:

The dashboard shows a summary of financial information such as net worth, spending trends, recent transactions, and budgets.

Why this feature is useful:

- Gives users a quick overview of their finances
- Makes financial information easy to understand
- Improves user experience.

2. Budgeting and Expense Tracking**Description:**

Users can set monthly budgets and track how much money they spend in categories such as food, transport, and rent.

Why this feature is useful:

- Helps control spending
- Shows where money is being used
- Helps users save money.

3. Net Worth Tracking**Description:**

The app automatically calculates net worth by combining assets and liabilities.

Why this feature is useful:

- Shows financial progress
- Helps users understand their financial growth
- Supports long-term financial planning.

4. Financial Goal Tracking**Description:**

Users can create goals such as saving for a house, vacation, or paying off debt.

Why this feature is useful:

- Motivates users to save
- Helps track progress toward financial goals.

Conclusion

Monarch Money is a modern financial management application designed to help users manage their finances effectively. Founded in 2018 by Val Agostino, Jon Sutherland, and Ozzie Osman, the app provides powerful tools such as budgeting, financial dashboards, net-worth tracking, and goal planning. Although the app requires a subscription and mainly supports the U.S.

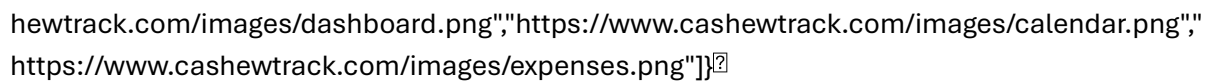
financial system, it remains one of the most advanced budgeting apps available. Many of its features—such as dashboards, expense tracking, and goal planning—can inspire developers who want to create their own budgeting applications.

References

- Monarch Money company profile –
- Vault Company Profile –
- CNBC Fintech News –
- The Company Check –
- Forbes Company Profile –

Cashew Budgeting App

Overview of the App

hewtrack.com/images/dashboard.png";"https://www.cashewtrack.com/images/calendar.png";"https://www.cashewtrack.com/images/expenses.png"]^[2]

Cashew — Expense Budget Tracker is a personal finance application designed to help users **track expenses, create budgets, and understand their spending habits**. The app allows users to record daily transactions, categorize expenses, and analyze financial data through charts and reports.

The main goal of the app is to **simplify money management** and provide users with a clear view of their financial behavior. The app focuses mainly on **expense tracking and budgeting**, rather than complex financial services like loans or investments.

The app is available on **mobile devices such as iPhone and Android** and includes features such as flexible budgeting, financial charts, and subscription tracking.

When the App Was Developed

The Cashew budgeting app was developed and published around **2023–2024** as a personal finance tracker available on mobile platforms. The application continues to receive updates and improvements, with new versions improving design, performance, and budgeting tools.

Founder / Developer

The app was developed by **James Kokoska**, an independent software developer who created the application to help users track their finances easily.

The developer designed the app with a **simple interface and easy-to-use budgeting system**, making it suitable for users who want to manage their money without complicated financial tools.

Strengths of the Cashew App

1. Simple and user-friendly interface

The app is designed with a clean interface that makes it easy for users to record expenses and view financial information.

2. Flexible budgeting system

Users can create budgets based on:

- weekly spending
- monthly spending
- custom time periods

This makes budgeting adaptable to different financial lifestyles.

3. Visual financial reports

The app displays financial data using:

- pie charts
- bar graphs

These visual tools help users better understand their spending patterns.

4. Subscription tracking

Users can track recurring expenses such as subscriptions and bills.

5. Multi-currency support

The app allows users to manage finances using different currencies with conversion rates.

Weaknesses of the Cashew App

1. Limited advanced financial tools

The app mainly focuses on expense tracking and budgeting and does not include advanced features like investment management.

2. Limited popularity compared to larger finance apps

Cashew is less well-known than apps like Mint or Monarch Money.

3. Some features require a paid version

The premium version unlocks additional features such as advanced analytics and customization.

Innovative Features of the Cashew App

1. Calendar view for transactions

The app allows users to view expenses in a **calendar format**, which makes it easier to see spending patterns over time.

2. Recurring transaction detection

Cashew automatically identifies recurring transactions such as bills and subscriptions.

3. Net worth tracking

The app calculates the user's **overall financial health** by tracking assets and expenses.

4. Weekly expense newsletter

The app can send a **weekly summary of expenses**, helping users stay informed about their spending habits.

Best Features You Can Use When Creating Your Own Budgeting App

1. Expense Categorization

Description:

The app automatically groups expenses into categories such as:

- food
- transport
- rent
- entertainment

This helps users understand where their money is going.

Why this feature is useful:

If you create your own budgeting app, this feature helps users **analyze spending patterns quickly**.

2. Calendar Expense Tracking

Description:

Cashew provides a **calendar view** where transactions are displayed according to the date they occurred.

Why this feature is useful:

- Shows spending trends over time
- Helps users track daily financial activity

3. Financial Charts and Reports

Description:

Charts and graphs convert financial data into visual insights.

Examples include:

- monthly spending charts
- category analysis graphs

These visualizations make financial information easier to understand.

4. Budget Goal Setting

Description:

Users can create budgeting goals such as:

- saving money
- reducing spending
- paying off debt

The app tracks progress toward these goals.

Why this feature is useful:

This motivates users to stay disciplined with their finances.

Conclusion

Cashew is a modern budgeting application designed to help users manage their finances through expense tracking, budgeting, and financial analysis. Developed by James Kokoska, the app focuses on simplicity and ease of use, making it suitable for individuals who want to monitor their spending habits. Its strengths include a user-friendly interface, visual financial reports, and flexible budgeting tools, while its weaknesses include limited advanced financial features. Features such as expense categorization, calendar transaction tracking, financial charts, and goal setting make the app useful and also provide inspiration for developers who want to create their own budgeting applications.

References

- Cashew Track Official Website.
- Apple App Store – Cashew Expense Budget Tracker.
- Cashews Finance Platform Features.

Comparison of WalletHub, Monarch Money, and Cashew Budgeting Apps

Feature	WalletHub	Monarch Money	Cashew
Year Developed	2013	2018	2023
Founder(s)	Odysseas Papadimitriou	Val Agostino, Jon Sutherland, Ozzie Osman	James Kokoska
Main Purpose	Credit monitoring and financial comparison	Complete personal finance management	Expense tracking and budgeting

Feature	WalletHub	Monarch Money	Cashew
Platform	Web and mobile app	Web, iOS, Android	Mobile app
Cost	Mostly free	Paid subscription	Free with premium version
Target Users	People monitoring credit scores	Individuals and families managing finances	Users who want simple expense tracking

Key Features Comparison

Feature	WalletHub	Monarch Money	Cashew
Financial dashboard	Yes	Yes	Yes
Budget planning	Limited	Advanced	Flexible
Expense tracking	Basic	Advanced	Very strong
Credit score tracking	Yes	No	No
Investment tracking	Limited	Yes	No
Net worth tracking	Yes	Yes	Limited
Financial goal planning	Yes	Yes	Yes
Subscription tracking	Yes	Yes	Yes

Strengths of Each App

WalletHub

Strengths

- Free credit score monitoring
- Financial product comparison tools
- Daily credit score updates
- Useful financial advice and research

Best for:

Users who want to monitor their **credit score and financial products**.

Monarch Money

Strengths

- Complete financial management system
- Advanced budgeting tools

- Investment tracking
- Family financial collaboration

Best for:

Users who want **all-in-one financial planning and budgeting**.

Cashew

Strengths

- Simple and easy-to-use interface
- Powerful expense tracking
- Visual spending charts
- Flexible budgeting system

Best for:

Users who want **simple daily expense tracking**.

Weaknesses of Each App

WalletHub

- Focuses mainly on the **U.S. financial system**
- Limited budgeting tools
- Requires personal financial information

Monarch Money

- Requires a **paid subscription**
- Some features are complex for beginners
- Mostly designed for U.S. users

Cashew

- Fewer advanced financial features
- Smaller developer team
- Limited investment tracking

Best Features You Should Use in Your Own Budgeting App

If you want to **create your own budgeting application**, you should combine the best features from the three apps.

Feature

Why It Is Important

Financial dashboard Gives users a quick overview of their finances

Feature	Why It Is Important
Expense tracking	Helps users understand spending habits
Budget planner	Allows users to control monthly spending
Financial goal tracking	Helps users save for future plans
Charts and reports	Makes financial data easier to understand
Subscription tracking	Helps users identify recurring payments
Net worth tracking	Shows overall financial health



1. Best Features You Should Implement in Your App

1. Smart Budget Dashboard

This feature is inspired by **Monarch Money** and **Cashew**.

What it does

- Shows total income, expenses, and savings in one place.
- Displays visual graphs and charts to track spending.
- Helps users quickly understand their financial situation.

Why it is important

- Users want a **simple overview of their finances** immediately after opening the app.

Example screen idea

- Total balance at the top
- Spending graph
- Categories like Food, Transport, Shopping

2. Automatic Expense Categorization

Inspired by **Monarch Money**.

What it does

- Automatically categorizes transactions (e.g., groceries, rent, transport).
- Reduces the need for manual input.

Why it matters

- Saves time for users and improves convenience.

Example categories

- Food

- Bills
- Transport
- Entertainment
- Savings

3. Wallet Score / Financial Health Score

Inspired by **WalletHub**.

What it does

- Gives users a **score showing their financial health**.
- The score improves when users:
 - Save money
 - Reduce unnecessary spending
 - Stick to their budget

Why it matters

- Makes budgeting **more engaging and motivating**.

Example

Score: 720 – Good Financial Health

4. Goal-Based Savings Tracker

Inspired by **Monarch Money**.

What it does

- Allows users to create savings goals such as:
 - Vacation
 - Emergency fund
 - New phone
 - Education

Features

- Progress bar
- Monthly saving suggestions
- Notifications

Why it matters

- Helps users stay motivated to save.

5. Simple Expense Tracker

Inspired by **Cashew**.

What it does

- Allows users to manually enter expenses quickly.
- Shows spending by category.

Example screen

- Add Expense
- Amount
- Category
- Date

Why it matters

- Some users prefer **manual control instead of bank syncing**.

6. Spending Alerts and Notifications

Inspired by **WalletHub**.

What it does

- Notifies users when:
 - They exceed their budget
 - Bills are due
 - Spending increases

Example alerts

- “You spent 80% of your food budget this month.”
- “Electricity bill due tomorrow.”

7. Financial Reports

Inspired by **Monarch Money**.

What it does

- Shows monthly financial reports.
- Helps users analyze spending patterns.

Example reports

- Monthly expenses
- Savings trends

- Category spending breakdown

2. Features That Can Make Your App Unique

To stand out from other budgeting apps, your app **FinWise Budget** can include:

AI Spending Insights

The app analyzes spending and gives advice like:

- “You spent 20% more on takeout this month.”
- “You could save \$50 by reducing subscriptions.”

Budget Challenges

Make budgeting fun by adding:

- Weekly saving challenges
- Spending limits
- Rewards or badges

Customizable Budget Categories

Users can create their own categories like:

- Beauty
- Pets
- Travel
- Hobbies

3. What You Should Look for to Ensure Your App is Successful

For your budgeting app to succeed, focus on these factors:

1. Simple User Interface

The app must be:

- Easy to use
- Clean
- Not overwhelming

Users should understand the app **within seconds**.

2. Strong Security

Since financial data is sensitive, the app should include:

- Data encryption
- Secure login

- Biometric login (fingerprint or face ID)

3. Personalization

Users should be able to:

- Customize budgets
- Set personal goals
- Choose notification preferences

4. Visual Financial Insights

Charts and graphs help users understand:

- Where their money goes
- How they can save more

5. Fast Performance

A successful app should:

- Load quickly
- Work smoothly
- Avoid crashes

4. Why Your App Can Be Successful

Your app **FinWise Budget** will succeed if it combines:

- The **financial score system** from WalletHub
- The **budget planning tools** from Monarch Money
- The **simplicity and clean design** of Cashew

This combination will create an app that is:

- Easy to use
- Motivating
- Powerful for budgeting

5. Example Summary of Your App

App Name: FinWise Budget

Purpose: Help users track spending, manage budgets, and improve financial health.

Main Features

- Budget dashboard
- Expense tracker

- Financial health score
- Goal-based savings
- Spending alerts
- Financial reports